



one tap to **hang out.**

THE VERIFIED SOCIAL GRAPH • COLUMBIA & BARNARD

WHY US

Four Columbia students building for our own campus.

Arjun Vaidya

MSCS @ Columbia

Dow Jones — consumer ML

Product & ML lead

Geonsik Moon

MSCS @ Columbia

ByteDance — recsys ML

Feed & recommendations

Inkeun Kim

MSCS @ Columbia

Full-stack — real-time apps

Shipping engineer

Alessandro Sayad

Columbia + École
Polytechnique

CMA CGM — strategy

Growth & campus ops

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Loneliest generation on record.

61%

of 18–25 yr olds report serious loneliness.

HARVARD • MCC 2021

71%

of Gen Z feels lonely. Boomers: 44%.

CIGNA • 2023

46%

of US teens online almost constantly.

PEW • 2024

WHY COLUMBIA FIRST

Everyone wants to hang out.
No one wants to be the one to ask.

39K

verified students at Columbia +
Barnard.

ENROLLMENT • 2025

36

acres on Morningside.

DENSEST URBAN CAMPUS,
U.S.

1.1K

students per acre. [.edu](#) verified only.

TRUST GATE

Three things became true at the same time.

01

Gen Z left the curated feed.

Locket: **#1 free app** at peak. Strava: **100M+** sharing live activity. Performance is out; presence is in.

02

Real-time is finally **cheap**.

Supabase + edge functions: two students ship a presence layer in a weekend. Five years ago — backend team, six figures.

03

Loneliness data is **undeniable**.

61% of 18–25 yr olds: serious loneliness (Harvard, 2021). Surgeon General: **+29%** heart disease, **+50%** dementia risk.

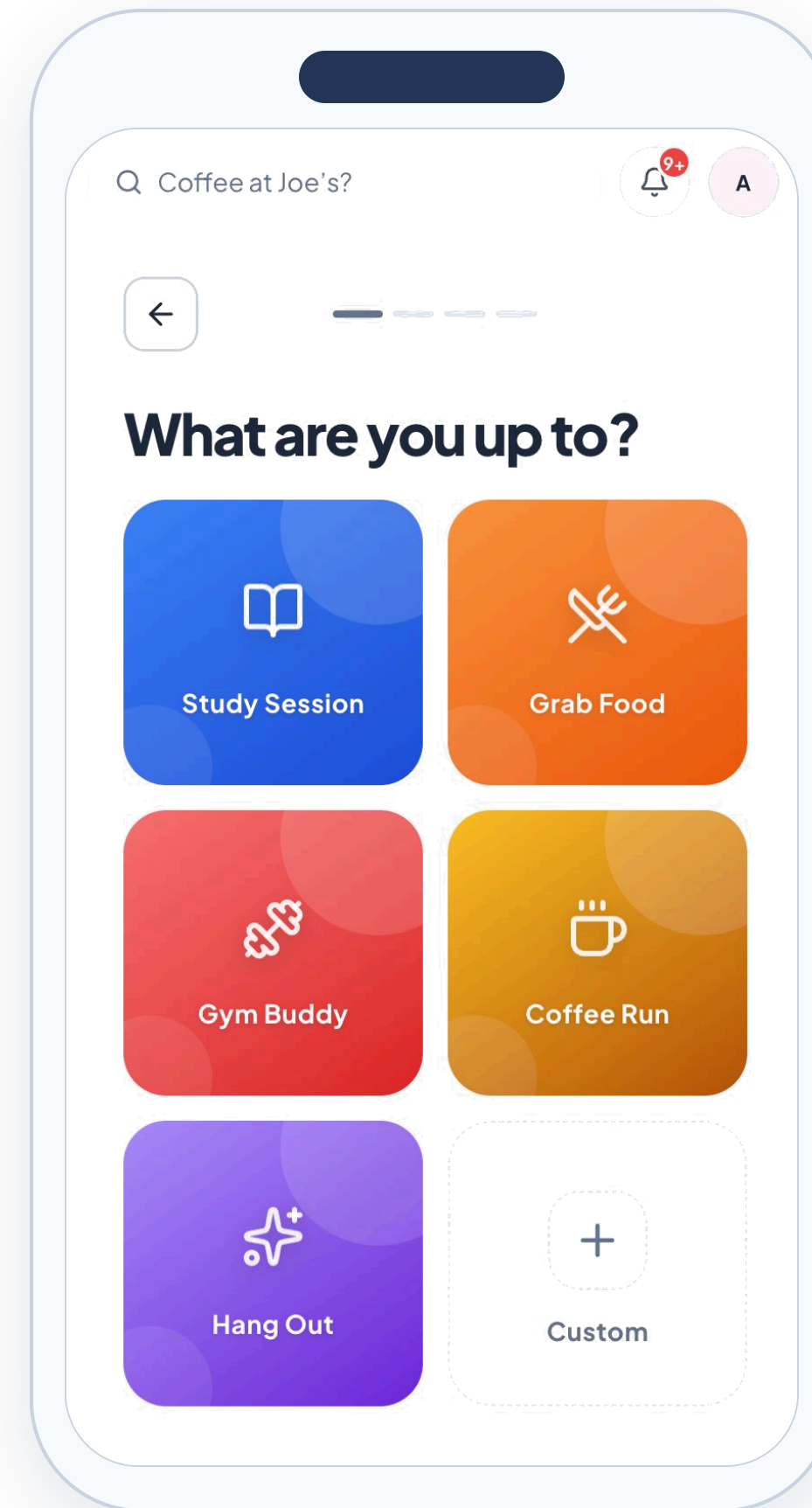
CIRCLES, IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

**You post what you're doing.
Right now. Others tap to join.**

That's it. No DMs. No coordinating across three group chats.

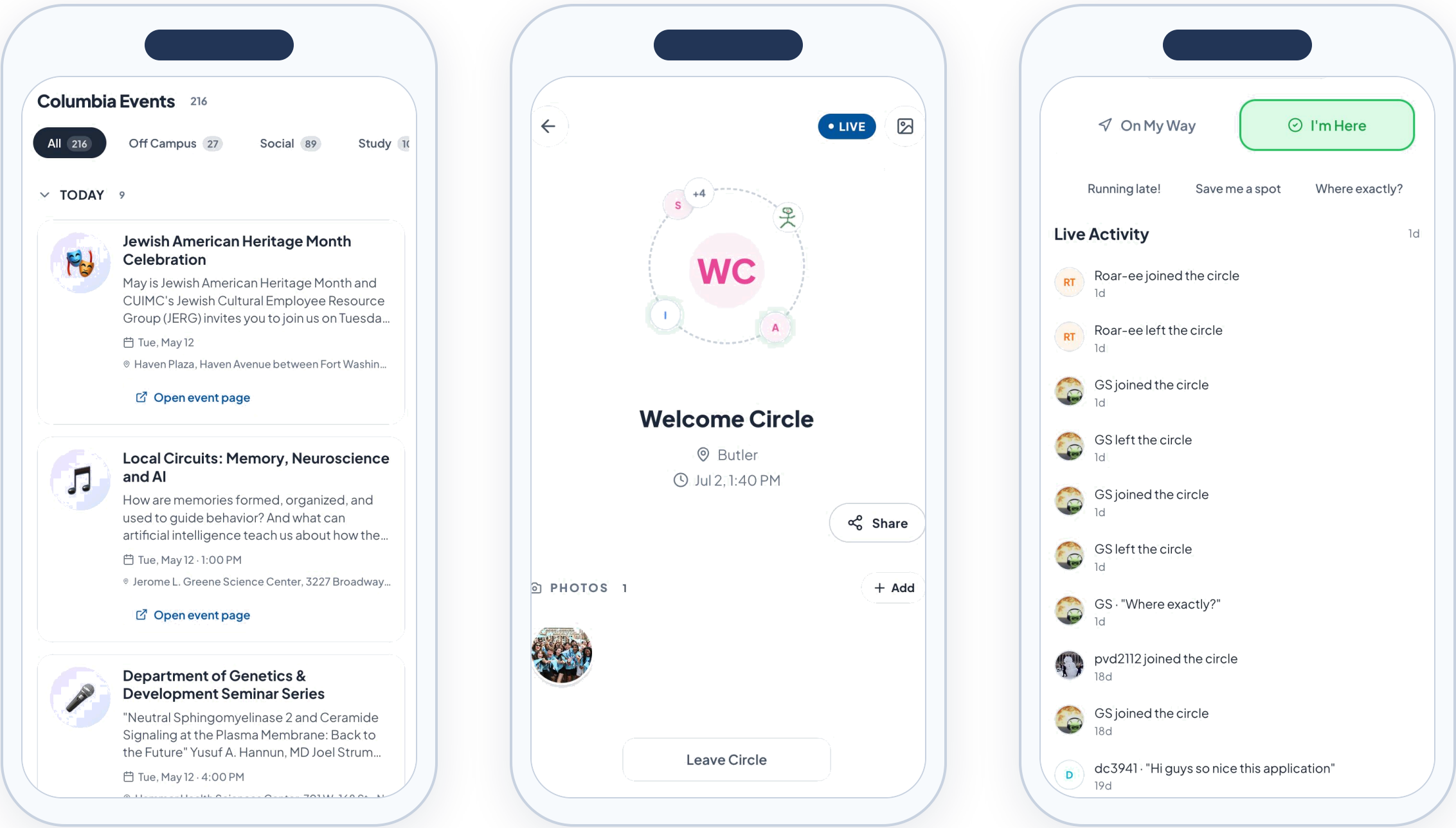
NETWORK

Verified Columbia and Barnard only. [.edu](#) email at signup; profile shows name, year, major.



HOW IT WORKS

Open the app. See campus, *alive*, in real time.



Open — The Pulse.

Join — host pinged.

Walk over — 30 sec.

WHAT STUDENTS DO TODAY

Every existing tool was built to ~~broadcast~~ — not invite.

GROUP CHATS**Decay by week 2.**

Built for known cliques, not discovery. You can't join one you're not already in.

SIDECCHAT · FIZZ**Anonymous venting.**

Zero intent to meet. Often makes campus feel **worse**, not better.

**TIKTOK ·
INSTAGRAM****57% on TikTok daily.**

Performance, not invitation.
Posting a story isn't asking.
(Pew, 2024)

THE DEFAULT**Doing **nothing**.**

61% of 18–25 yr olds report serious loneliness. **That's the actual competitor.**

THE SEED SIGNAL

Shipped. Instrumented. Validated on campus.

TODAY

LIVE IN PRODUCTION

circlesmain.vercel.app

Mobile-first SPA on Supabase. Realtime feed, .edu auth, friends graph, Columbia events imported.

VALIDATED ON R/COLUMBIA

"Great to see all campus events in a single place instead of sifting through emails or posters."

Unprompted, top reply on our subreddit launch.

INSTRUMENTED FROM DAY ONE

GA4 + Amplitude.

Activation funnel measured. **14%** view-to-signup baseline. Shipping fixes — contextual prompts, social proof, trust copy.

BY DEMO DAY • THEN 18 MONTHS

100+

verified students by Demo Day. **20%** D7 retention.

60%

Morningside penetration in 18 months.

8

Tier 1 campuses online. **24K** verified students.

HOW CIRCLES MAKES MONEY

Free for students. Always.

We monetize the network, not the user.

YEAR 1

Local merchants.

Hyperlocal sponsored Circles from Morningside operators — Hungarian Pastry, Joe Coffee, Mel's, Le Monde.

\$50 – \$200

per sponsored Circle. Capped per-feed ratio.

YEAR 2

Campus events & clubs.

Promoted Circles for ~500 student orgs at Columbia. Premium analytics. Event sponsorship slots.

\$25 / MO

org subscriptions. ~5% pilot conversion.

YEAR 3+

Verified network licensing.

License the verified-student-presence layer to peer universities, and to brands paying a premium for real, opted-in college reach.

\$30 / STUDENT / YR

~\$1.8M ARR per 100K-student campus at 60% capture.

MARKET • BOTTOM-UP

One campus. Then eight. Then every campus.

01 Beachhead — Columbia + Barnard.

39,247 verified students. Densest urban campus in the U.S. Capture target: **60%+** in 18 months.

02 Tier 1 — eight peer urban universities.

NYU, Penn, Harvard, Yale, Stanford, USC, Georgetown, Northwestern. **~240K** students. Same density, same data.

03 Tier 2 — every U.S. campus.

19.3M higher-ed students (NCES, 2024). SAM at \$30 / student / yr = **\$579M** annual ceiling.

LONG TERM • GLOBAL

200

*colleges. The platform becomes
the verified social graph this
generation actually uses.*

CIRCLES · SPRING 2026

Help us own Morningside.

One tap to hang out. Verified Columbia and Barnard.
Live at circlesmain.vercel.app.

RAISING \$100K · 24 MO RUNWAY

Campus growth ops	\$40K
Product & infra	\$35K
Brand & design	\$25K

MILESTONES

06	100+ verified students. 20% D7.
12	5K Morningside. First merchant pilots.
18	60% Morningside. NYU pilot. Seed-ready.

● circles

VAIDYA · MOON · KIM · SAYAD